Division of Enterprise Technology Strategy and Services

Enterprise Technology Strategy and Services Policy 09-01

Cell Phone and Mobile Broadband Devices

Last Revision: 4/21/2025

doa.entsec@doit.ri.gov

1. Purpose

Identify the process and procedures for the procurement and support of cellular telephones and mobile broadband devices (commonly referred to as air cards or hotspots).

2. Applicability

This policy is applicable to all State of Rhode Island Executive Branch Departments[1] (including agencies, boards, and commissions), and their employees (including permanent, non-permanent, full-time, and part-time) and interns, consultants, contractors, vendors, contracted individuals, and any entity having access to state information systems and data, whether operated or maintained by the state or on behalf of the state. For this policy, the term "agency" is used to refer to any department, agency, division, or unit of the Executive branch of the State of Rhode Island.

a. Unless otherwise specifically provided, the Telecommunications Section of the Division of Enterprise Technology Strategy and Services (ETSS) is responsible for the procurement, deployment, installation, synchronization, trouble resolution, and repair of all cellular telephones and mobile broadband devices as well as the training necessary to utilize the device.

b. Only state procured and issued devices will be supported by ETSS.

c. State issued cellular phones are not to be used as a replacement for a personal cellular phone. Further guidance is provided in this policy regarding reimbursement procedures. In accordance with Accounts and Control Policy A-69 (State-Issued Cellular Phones and other Mobile Devices), incidental and infrequent use for personal reasons is allowed provided specific requirements are met (see section 6, Personal Use, below).

3. Assignment

a. The assignment of cellular telephones and mobile broadband devices will be based upon the functional requirements of an individual's position and shall be limited to the following areas as determined and authorized by the funding agency:

   i. Crisis Management

   ii. Emergency Management

   iii. Productivity Requirements

   iv. Communications

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[1] *State of Rhode Island Executive Branch Departments does not include the University of Rhode Island, the State Colleges, the General Treasurer, the Attorney General, or the Secretary of State.*

b. All requests for the assignment of mobile broadband devices must be submitted in writing. The request form can be found at ETSS Telecommunications Request Form. The user should state reasons why each assignment is necessary and must be approved by both the requesting agency or department designee and agency Chief Financial Officer (CFO) and submitted to the ETSS service desk for processing.

c. No individual shall be issued more than one (1) cellular telephone without a written request for exception submitted to the ETSS Chief Digital Officer (CDO) by the agency leadership designee and agency CFO.

4. Service and Support

a. All requests for procurement, installation, synchronization, trouble resolution, repair or training for cellular phones must be submitted to the ETSS Service Desk. The service desk can be reached via the ETSS IT Service Desk portal: Service Portal - Enterprise Technology Strategy & Services.

b. In accordance with the Master Price Agreement (MPA) for Cellular Telephone Services that has been approved by the Division of Purchases, only ETSS Telecommunications staff (Telecom staff) are authorized to deal directly with the vendors.

c. Individuals are not authorized to bring their cellular telephone to any vendor service center for any reason without the prior approval of Telecomm staff.

d. All cellular telephones and mobile broadband devices issued to employees are state property and as such must be returned to the ETSS Telecommunications team when no longer needed by the individual to whom it was assigned.

e. Transfer of state issued cell phone numbers to a private phone is not authorized and will not be approved in any instance.

f. The downloading and installation of third-party applications, e.g., Instant Messaging, Facebook, X (Formerly Twitter), Weather Bug etc., is not authorized and may be remotely removed upon detection. The setup of third party or personal accounts on state issued devices is not authorized. These will be removed when detected.

5. Security

a. According to the rules and policies established by ETSS, applicable security settings will be configured at the time of issuance. Maintaining the security settings of all cellular telephones and mobile broadband devices is mandatory.

b. All users are required to password protect their devices with a password consisting of at least 6 alphanumeric characters. Users are not authorized to turn off the password.

c. All state issued mobile broadband devices, commonly referred to as hotspot devices, will be configured with WPA2 security at a minimum with an appropriate password to prevent unauthorized access.

6. Personal Use

a. State issued cellular telephones are issued to individuals to permit them to perform the assigned duties in the most efficient manner.

b. State issued cellular phones are not to be used as a replacement for a personal cellular phone. However, in accordance with Accounts and Control Policy A-69 (State-Issued Cellular Phones and other Mobile Devices) , incidental and infrequent use for personal reasons is allowed if the use is:

i. Infrequent, appropriate and short in duration

ii. Such that it does not involve added cost to the agency

iii. Such that it does not interfere with work

iv. In compliance with State Network Device Security Policy10-04

7. ETSS Procedure

a. When the Telecomm Request Form is submitted to ETSS, the Telecomm staff will begin the procurement process.

b. When the device is received, Telecom staff will contact the user to either pick up the device or plan to meet with the individual to perform the setup and/or configuration needed.

c. All requests for repair or other types of support must also be submitted to the ETSS Service Desk.

d. No one other than Telecom staff is authorized to provide any support for devices without the expressed approval of Telecom staff.

e. Damaged or broken devices must be returned to the ETSS Telecommunications team, who will determine if the device can be repaired or will require replacement.

f. Prior to disposal of any device, all memory will be erased by the Telecom staff to ensure that any sensitive information is removed.

g. For device upgrade requests, the user must enter a ticket into ETSS Service Desk Portal to request the upgrade. Telecomm verifies whether the device is eligible for upgrade and, if yes, sends the user a cost approval form which must be signed off by the agency CFO. The user then signs and sends the form back to Telecomm for processing.

h. If a device is lost or stolen, the user should immediately contact Telecomm via email to the Service Desk (ent.servicedesk@ri.gov) to open the ticket to investigate.

i. For device deactivation, a ticket should be opened with the service desk at ent.servicedesk@ri.gov requesting deactivation.

j. For overseas travel requests, the user must open a Service Desk Ticket, search for "International" in the search box, select "ETSS Overseas / Out of Country Travel Request Form" from the search results, then complete and submit the required forms no less than 2 weeks prior to traveling to ensure equipment configurations or requisition requirements can be met.

8. Approval / Review Signatures:

Osiris Gonzalez Digitally signed by Osiris Gonzalez Date: 2025.04.21 10:42:26 -04'00'

Deputy Chief of Infrastructure

Nathan Loura Digitally signed by Nathan Loura Date: 2025.04.21 10:54:32 -04'00'

Chief Information Security Officer

Brian Tardiff Digitally signed by Brian Tardiff Date: 2025.04.21 11:22:03 -04'00'

Chief Digital Officer